



Explain Sources of Power

Introduction

Power is the ability to influence others.

French & Raven identified five sources of power.

1. Legitimate Power

- Comes from position
Example: Manager
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2. Reward Power

- Ability to give rewards
Example: Promotion, bonus
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3. Coercive Power

- Ability to punish
Example: Suspension
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4. Expert Power

- Based on knowledge and skills
Example: Senior software engineer
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5. Referent Power

- Based on admiration and respect
Example: Charismatic leader
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Conclusion

Power helps leaders influence employees. Proper use of power improves organizational effectiveness.



Power and Politics

Meaning of Organizational Politics

Use of power to influence decisions for personal benefit.

Reasons for Politics

1. Scarce resources
 2. Promotions
 3. Power struggle
 4. Unclear roles
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Positive Effects

- Healthy competition
 - Faster decisions
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Negative Effects

- Conflict
 - Stress
 - Reduced morale
 - Low productivity
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Conclusion

Politics cannot be completely avoided but should be controlled to maintain healthy work environment.